

- (ii) Scheduling is not possible
- (iii) Connection handling is not visible to the user

3. **NeoLoad.** NeoLoad is a load and performance testing tool used to measure and analyse the performance of web and mobile applications.

NeoLoad helps in analysing the

performance of a web application by increasing traffic to the application and monitoring performance under heavy load conditions. It is designed and developed by a French company named Neotys. It is written in Java and is available in English and French languages.

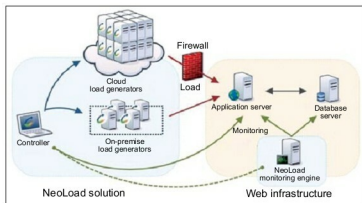


Fig. 4: Working of NeoLoad

How it works. NeoLoad has two main components: the controller and the load generator

The controller. Provides a graphical interface from which the user can create and record scenarios, run tests and analyse the results. It monitors

the web infrastructure's various components without installing any agents on the server

The load generator. The load generator simulates users accessing the application being tested. It also collects information about the application's performance

NeoLoad is compatible with all web servers and web application servers like J2EE, .NET, PHP, ASP, CGI, AJAX and SOAP. The main features of this tool are that it supports Digest, Basic, NTLM and form-based authentication. It also supports client certificate authentication. It supports hybrid and native mobile application, and also JSON and SPDY protocol. NeoLoad does not cover all bases on protocols such as Citrix ICA or RDP.

4. **SOASTA's CloudTest.** Cloud testing is a type of software testing in which web applications use cloud infrastructures to simulate real-world traffic. SOASTA's CloudTest is one of the industry's best selling software to perform cloud performance testing. It has the capacity to simulate thousands of users to use the application at the same time. It increases the traffic on the website to monitor the actual performance under peak load condition.

CloudTest is designed and developed by the American company SOASTA, Inc. This is not a free software. The trial version is available.

Some of the benefits of using this tool are that it lives in the cloud, so there is no need for the associated headaches of installation, managing injectors, controllers and analysis tools. Software also has advanced deploy and diagnostic capabilities—if a service fails on a cloud host, it detects and redeploys automatically. SOASTA provides run-time load analysis. This allows detection and investigation of issues as they happen.

Some other tools are listed in Table V. ●

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TABLE III
Overview of NeoLoad

Version	4.1.3
Availability	Licensed
Cost	Euro 29,026
System requirement	Microsoft Windows, Linux and Solaris

TABLE IV
Overview of SOASTA's CloudTest

Version	2.9
Availability	Licensed
Cost	Free for 100 users
System requirement	Windows, Linux and Mac OS

TABLE V
List of Some Commonly Used Tools

Tool name	Company	Cost	Description	Technology supported
Silk Performer	Borland	Licensed	A performance testing tool used for enterprise, mobile and web-based applications. It ensures the scalability, performance and reliability of an enterprise's applications	SOA, SAP, Peoplesoft, Oracle, Citrix, web-based model, CoE operational model
SOAtest	Parasoft	Licensed	An automated testing tool used to test the functionality and performance of an application. It also finds concurrency issues. It ensures the reliability, security and compliance of SOA, cloud and web applications	SOA, JUnit
Raw Load Tester	NA	Open source	A free load testing tool. Does not have many features but useful in a situation where using a complete solution for load testing is not practical like Apache Flood	JavaScript
LoadUI	SmartBear	Open source	A load testing tool that is free and platform independent	SOAP POX, JDBC, REST, Web and HTTPS
LoadStorm	LoadStorm	Licensed	The cheapest available cloud load testing tool for web applications	Cloud-based application